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Uploading files via distributed devices

Abstract

In one disclosed method, a method performed by a computing system involves determining that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system; sending, to the first remote device, first data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first remote device and a second remote device; receiving, from the first remote device, a first portion of the file; receiving, from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device via the wireless connection; and merging the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Various file sharing systems have been developed that allow users to share files or other data. ShareFile®, offered by Citrix Systems, Inc., of Fort Lauderdale, FL, is one example of such a file sharing system.

SUMMARY

(2) This Summary is provided to introduce a selection of concepts in a simplified form that are further described below in the Detailed Description. This Summary is not intended to identify key features or essential features, nor is it intended to limit the scope of the claims included herewith.

(3) In some of the disclosed embodiments, a method comprises determining, by a computing system, that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system; sending, from the computing system to the first remote device, first data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first remote device and a second remote device; receiving, by the computing system and from the first remote device, a first portion of the file; receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device via the wireless connection; and merging, by the computing system, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.

(4) In some embodiments, a method comprises determining, by a computing system, that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system; determining, by the computing system, that at least a second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system; receiving, by the computing system and from the first remote device, a first portion of the file; receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device; and merging, by the computing system, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.

(5) In some embodiments, a method comprises determining, by a first device, that a file is to be uploaded from the first device to a remote computing system; establishing, by the first device, a wireless connection with at least a second device in proximity of the first device; dividing, by the first device, the file into at least a first portion and a second portion; sending, from the first device to the second device via the wireless connection, the first portion of the file; and sending, from the first device and to the remote computing system, the second portion of the file.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Objects, aspects, features, and advantages of embodiments disclosed herein will become more

fully apparent from the following detailed description, the appended claims, and the accompanying figures in which like reference numerals identify similar or identical elements. Reference numerals that are introduced in the specification in association with a figure may be repeated in one or more subsequent figures without additional description in the specification in order to provide context for other features, and not every element may be labeled in every figure. The drawings are not necessarily to scale, emphasis instead being placed upon illustrating embodiments, principles and concepts. The drawings are not intended to limit the scope of the claims included herewith.

(2) FIG. 1A is a high-level diagram illustrating a computing system orchestrating collaborative uploading of a file by multiple client devices within a proximity, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure;

(3) FIG. 1B is a high-level diagram illustrating a computing system orchestrating collaborative uploading of a file by multiple client devices within a proximity, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure;

(4) FIG. 1C is a high-level diagram illustrating a host device initiating a collaborative upload of a file for one or more client devices within a proximity, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure;

(5) FIG. 2 is a diagram of a network environment in which some embodiments of the present disclosure may be deployed;

(6) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a computing system that may be used to implement one or more of the components of the computing environment shown in FIG. 2 in accordance with some embodiments;

(7) FIG. 4 is a schematic block diagram of a cloud computing environment in which various aspects of the disclosure may be implemented;

(8) FIG. 5A is a diagram illustrating how a network computing environment like one shown in FIG. 2 may be configured to allow clients access to an example embodiment of a file sharing system;

(9) FIG. 5B is a diagram illustrating certain operations that may be performed by the file sharing system shown in FIG. 5A in accordance with some embodiments;

(10) FIG. 5C is a diagram illustrating additional operations that may be performed by the file sharing system shown in FIG. 5A in accordance with some embodiments;

(11) FIG. 6A illustrates a first step of an example process for collaboratively uploading a file to a computing system from multiple client devices within a proximity, in accordance with some embodiments;

(12) FIG. 6B illustrates a second step of an example process for collaboratively uploading a file to a computing system from multiple client devices within a proximity, in accordance with some embodiments;

(13) FIG. 6C illustrates a third step of an example process for collaboratively uploading a file to a computing system from multiple client devices within a proximity, in accordance with some embodiments;

(14) FIG. 6D illustrates a fourth step of an example process for collaboratively uploading a file to a computing system from multiple client devices within a proximity, in accordance with some embodiments;

(15) FIG. 7A illustrates an example routine that may be performed by an application of a client device shown in FIGS. 1A-1C and 6A-6D to initiate the collaborative uploading of a file or data object in accordance with some embodiments;

(16) FIG. 7B illustrates an example routine that may be performed by the computing system shown in FIGS. 1A-1C and 6A-6D to orchestrate the collaborative uploading of a file or data object from a client device in accordance with some embodiments;

(17) FIG. 8A illustrates a first portion of an example process for collaboratively uploading a file to a computing system from multiple client devices based on a proximity of the client devices, in accordance with some embodiments;

(18) FIG. 8B illustrates a second portion of the example process partially depicted in FIG. 8A; and (19) FIG. 8C illustrates a third portion of the example process partially depicted in FIG. 8A.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(20) For purposes of reading the description of the various embodiments below, the following descriptions of the sections of the specification and their respective contents may be helpful:

(21) Section A provides an introduction to example embodiments of a system for uploading files via distributed devices;

(22) Section B describes a network environment which may be useful for practicing embodiments described herein;

(23) Section C describes a computing system which may be useful for practicing embodiments described herein;

(24) Section D describes embodiments of systems and methods for delivering shared resources using a cloud computing environment;

(25) Section E describes example embodiments of systems for providing file sharing over networks;

(26) Section F provides a more detailed description of example embodiments of the system introduced in Section A; and

(27) Section G describes example implementations of methods, systems/devices, and computer-readable media in accordance with the present disclosure.

(28) A. Introduction to Illustrative Embodiments of a System for Uploading Files Using Distributed Devices

(29) Various file sharing systems have been developed that allow users to share files with other users over a network. However, when uploading a file to a server, such as a large file, it may be a lengthy process and may demand processing resources from the uploading device during the upload process. Additionally, upload speeds are oftentimes significantly slower than download speeds, thus further increasing the file upload time.

(30) The inventors have recognized and appreciated that in many scenarios where a user is attempting to upload a file, such as to a file sharing system, there may be a group of users that also are users of the same file sharing system. Additionally, at least some of the group of users may be physically located within a proximity of each other, such as in an office environment or at a conference. Thus, instead of an individual user attempting to upload the whole file to a file server of the file sharing system, an opportunity may exist, based on the proximity of users and their respective devices, for portions of the file to be distributed to the users' devices within the proximity and for the devices to individually upload portions of the file. The file portions may then be merged back into the file by the file server.

(31) An example file sharing system **504** that includes a file server with which the collaborative uploading techniques described herein may be employed is described below (in Section E) in connection with FIGS. 5A-C. As explained in Section E, in some implementations, one client device **202** may upload a file **502** (shown in FIG. 5A) to a central repository of the file sharing system **504**, such as the storage medium(s) **512** shown in FIGS. 5A-C, and another client device **202** may then download a copy of that file **502** from the same repository. As Section E also describes, in some implementations, an access management system **506** may regulate the circumstances in which files **502** may be uploaded and/or downloaded to/from a storage system **508** (including the storage medium **512**(s)) by various client devices **202**.

(32) Offered are systems and techniques for dividing a file into multiple data fragments (referred to herein as “chunks”) and uploading different ones of those chunks from respective client devices **202** that are located within a physical proximity of one another to a file server (e.g., within the file sharing system **504**). Because the respective client devices **202** are located within the same physical proximity, the device originating the file upload may send different chunks of the file to individual client devices **202** (e.g., via one or more wireless peer-to-peer connections) and thus enable the

respective client devices **202** to individually upload their respective chunks to the file server. In some implementations, the file server may assemble the chunks to generate a complete copy of the file.

(33) This approach may simplify the upload process for a user/client device and provide a method to upload data objects seamlessly in an efficient method that effectively utilizes available resources. Devices with hardware limitations, e.g., limited processing power, and/or devices connected to networks with limited bandwidth availability, e.g., certain cellular networks, may upload files quickly and seamlessly with this approach. This may provide for the upload processing time for the uploading device and the receiving the storage system **508** to be reduced and enable the storage system **508** of the file sharing system **504** to cater to other file requests sooner.

(34) FIG. 1A is a high-level diagram illustrating how a computing system **100** may facilitate collaborative uploading of a file **108** from multiple client devices **202** (e.g., a first device **102** and a second device **104**) within a proximity of one another, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. In some embodiments, the computing system **100** may be part of the file sharing system **504**. In other embodiments, the file sharing system **504** may be in communication with the computing system **100**. In some embodiments, the computing system **100** may include one or more servers **204** (examples of which are described below in relation to FIG. 2). For example, in some implementations, the server(s) **204** used to implement the computing system **100** may be included amongst the server(s) **204b** of the storage system **508** described in Section E.

(35) The first device **102** and the second device **104** may be respective client devices **202** (examples of which are described in Sections B-D below). Although only two such client devices **202** are shown in FIG. 1A, it should be appreciated that additional client devices **202** may be employed in some implementations. A client device **202** (e.g., the first device **102**) may be in communication with the computing system **100** using one or more networks **206** (examples of which are described below). A client device **202** (e.g., the first device **102**) may store the file **108**. In some implementations, a client application may be installed on the client devices **202** and a user may use such a client application to request to upload the file **108** to the computing system **100**. In some implementations, the user of client device **202** may alternatively use a browser-based client application to request the upload of the file **108** to the computing system **100**. The file management application **513** described in Section E (in connection with FIG. 5A) is an example of a client application that may be used for such purposes.

(36) A first example routine **120** that may be performed by the computing system **100** is illustrated in FIG. 1A. As shown in FIG. 1A, at a step **122** of the routine **120**, the computing system **100** may determine that a file **108** is to be uploaded from a first device **102** to the computing system **100**. In some implementations, such determination may be based on the receipt of a request from the first device **102** to upload the file **108**. Further, in some implementations, such a request to upload the file **108** may include an indication of the client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104**) within a physical proximity of the first device **102**.

(37) In some implementations, the first device **102** may detect one or more other client devices **202** within the same vicinity. For example, in some implementations, the first device **102** may use a short range wireless radio, such as a Bluetooth or Wi-Fi transceiver, to identify one or more other client devices **202** within a physical proximity. In some implementations, the detection of one or more other client devices **202** within a proximity may be performed by the first device **102** in response to the user making a request, via a client application, to upload the file **108** to the computing system **100**.

(38) At a step **124** of the routine **120**, the computing system **100** may send first data to the first device **102** to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first device **102** other client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104**) within a physical proximity of the first device **102**. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may configure such data to cause the first device **102** to establish a wireless network to which the second device **104** may connect. In some

implementations, the first data sent from the computing system **100** to the first device **102** may enable peer-to-peer communication between the first device **102** and the second device **104**. For example, the computing system **100** may provide the first device **102** with instructions for establishing a Wi-Fi hotspot, with the instructions indicating the Wi-Fi hotspot name, the service set identifier (SSID) for the hotspot, and a password to be used to access the hotspot.

(39) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may additionally or alternatively send second data to the second device **104** to enable a wireless connection to be established between the second device **104** and the first device **102**. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may configure such data to enable the second device **104** to connect to the wireless network established by the first device **102**. In some implementations, the second data the computing system **100** sends to the second device **104** may enable peer-to-peer communication between the second device **104** and the first device **102**, thus enabling a transfer of the second portion of the file **108** from the first device **102**. For example, in some implementations, the second data may include the Wi-Fi name and the password for connecting to the Wi-Fi hotspot of the first device **102**.

(40) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may additionally transmit a request to the second device **104** (and perhaps other client devices **202** within a physical proximity of the first device **102**) for authorization to assist in uploading the file **108** from the first device **102** to the computing system **100** using collaborative uploading. The devices receiving the authorization request (e.g., the second device **104**) may output prompts (e.g., via client applications) for user authorization to assist in uploading the file **108** with collaborative uploading. The respective client devices **202** may transmit the user authorization or denial to the computing system **100**.

(41) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may determine a proximity group, for example, based on the one or more client devices **202** that (A) were identified by the requesting client device **202** (e.g., the first device **102**) as being within a physical proximity, and (B) provided authorization to assist in uploading the file **108** using collaborative uploading. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may transmit to the first device **102** information indicating the number of client devices **202** in the proximity group and/or the identity of those client devices **202**.

(42) As shown in FIG. 1A, at step **126** of the routine **120**, the computing system **100** may receive from the first device **102** a first portion of the file. At a step **128** of the routine **120**, the computing system **100** may receive, from the second device **104**, a second portion of the file **108**. In some implementations, the second device **104** may have received the second portion of the file **108** from the first devices **102**, such as via a peer-to-peer communication channel, as described above.

(43) At a step **130** of the routine **120**, the computing system **100** may merge the first portion of the file **108** and the second portion of the file **108** to generate a copy of the file **108**. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may send a first key (e.g., a public key) to the first device **102** to encrypt the file **108** or the file portions of the file **108**. When encryption is employed, the computing system **100** may decrypt the copy of the file **108** or the received file portions using a second key (e.g., a private key).

(44) A second example routine **140** that may be performed by the computing system **100** is illustrated in FIG. 1B. As shown in FIG. 1B, at a step **142** of the routine **140**, the computing system **100** may determine that a file **108** is to be uploaded from a first device **102** to the computing system **100**. In some implementations, the determination may be based on receipt of a request from the first device **102** to upload the file **108**. Further, in some implementations, such a request to upload the file **108** may include an indication of the client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104**) within a physical proximity of the first device **102**.

(45) At a step **144** of the routine **140**, the computing system **100** may determine that at least a second device **104** is available to assist the first device **102** in uploading the file **108** to the computing system **100**. In some implementations, the first device **102** may detect one or more other client devices **202** within the same vicinity. For example, in some implementations, the first device

102 may use a short range wireless radio, such as a Bluetooth or Wi-Fi transceiver, to identify one or more other client devices **202** within a physical proximity. In some implementations, the detection of one or more other client devices **202** within a proximity may be performed by the first device **102** in response to the user making a request, via a client application, to upload the file **108** to the computing system **100**.

(46) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may send first data to the first device **102** to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first device **102** other client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104**) within a physical proximity of the first device **102**. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may configure such data to cause the first device **102** to establish a wireless network to which the second device **104** may connect. In some implementations, the first data sent from the computing system **100** to the first device **102** may enable peer-to-peer communication between the first device **102** and the second device **104**. For example, the computing system **100** may provide the first device **102** with instructions for establishing a Wi-Fi hotspot, with the instructions indicating the Wi-Fi hotspot name, the service set identifier (SSID) for the hotspot, and a password to be used to access the hotspot.

(47) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may additionally or alternatively send second data to the second device **104** to enable a wireless connection to be established between the second device **104** and the first device **102**. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may configure such data to enable the second device to connect to the wireless network established by the first device **102**. In some implementations, the second data the computing system **100** sends to the second device **104** may enable peer-to-peer communication between the second device **104** and the first device **102**, thus enabling a transfer of the second portion of the file **108** from the first device **102**. For example, in some implementations, the second data may include the Wi-Fi name and the password for connecting to the Wi-Fi hotspot of the first device **102**.

(48) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may additionally transmit a request to the second device **104** (and perhaps other client devices **202** within a physical proximity of the first device **102**) for authorization to assist in uploading the file **108** from the first device **102** to the computing system **100** using collaborative uploading. The devices receiving the authorization request (e.g., the second device **104**) may output prompts (e.g., via client applications) for user authorization to assist in uploading the file **108** with collaborative uploading. The respective client devices **202** may transmit the user authorization or denial to the computing system **100**.

(49) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may determine a proximity group, for example, based on the one or more client devices **202** that (A) were identified by the requesting client device **202** (e.g., the first device **102**) as being within a physical proximity, and (B) provided authorization to assist in uploading the file **108** using collaborative uploading. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may transmit to the first device **102** information indicating the number of client devices **202** in the proximity group and/or the identity of those client devices **202**.

(50) As shown in FIG. 1B, at step **146** of the routine **140**, the computing system **100** may receive from the first device **102** a first portion of the file. At a step **148** of the routine **140**, the computing system **100** may receive, from the second device **104**, a second portion of the file **108**. In some implementations, the second device **104** may have received the second portion of the file **108** from the first devices **102**, such as via the peer-to-peer communication channel, as described above.

(51) At step **150** of the routine **140**, the computing system **100** may merge the first portion of the file **108** and the second portion of the file **108** to generate a copy of the file **108**. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may send a first key (e.g., a public key) to the first device **102** to encrypt the file **108** or the file portions of the file **108**. When encryption is employed, the computing system **100** may decrypt the copy of the file **108** or the received file portions using a second key (e.g., a private key).

(52) FIG. 1C shows an example routine **160** that may be performed by a client device **202** (e.g., the

first device **102**) to orchestrate a collaborative upload of a file **108** by multiple client devices **202** (e.g., by at least the first device **102** and the second device **104**) within a proximity of one another, in accordance with some embodiments of the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. **1C**, at step **162** of the routine **160**, the first device **102** may determine that a file **108** is to be uploaded from the first device **102** to the computing system **100**.

(53) In some implementations, the first device **102** may determine that at least one client device **202** (e.g., the second device **104**) is within a proximity of the first device **102**. In some implementations, the determination that the second device **104** is within a proximity of the first device **102** may be in response to the first device **102** detecting a Bluetooth transmission identifying the second device **104**. In some implementations, the first device **102** may send to the computing system **100** an indication that the second device **104** is within the proximity of the first device **102**. As noted above, in some implementations, the computing system **100** may be a part of the file sharing system **504** (shown in FIGS. **5A-C**), and the file **108** may be stored in the storage system **508**.

(54) At step **164** of the routine **160**, the first device **102** may establish a wireless connection with at least the second device **104** within a proximity of the first device **102**. In some implementations, after sending the computing system **100** the indication that the second device **104** is within the proximity of the first device **102**, the first device **102** may receive, from the computing system **100**, data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first device **102** and the second device **104**. For example, as noted above, in some implementations, the first device **102** may receive instructions from the computing system **100** to establish a Wi-Fi hotspot, and the computing system **100** may additionally send to the second device **104** instructions for connecting to that hotspot. Accordingly, in such implementations, the first device **102** may establish a wireless connection with the second device **104** as a result of the second device **104** connecting to the Wi-Fi hotspot established by the first device **102**.

(55) In some implementations, the first device **102** may receive information indicating the number of client devices **202** in the proximity group and/or the identity of those client devices **202**. At step **166** of the routine **160**, the first device **102** may divide the file **108** into at least a first portion and a second portion. The number of client devices **202** in the proximity group may be used by the first device **102** to determine the number of file portions to divide the file **108**. In some implementations, the first device **102** may receive a key (e.g., a public key) from the computing system **100**. The first device **102** may encrypt the file **108** or the file portions of file **108** using the received key.

(56) At step **168** of the routine **160**, the first device **102** may send, to the second device **104**, the second portion of the file **108** via the wireless connection established between the first device **102** and the second device **104**, such as via a Wi-Fi hotspot of the first device **102**, as described above. At step **170** of the routine **160**, the first device **102** may send, to the computing system **100**, the first portion of the file **108**.

(57) Additional details and example implementations of embodiments of the present disclosure are set forth below in Section F, following a description of example systems and network environments in which such embodiments may be deployed.

(58) B. Network Environment

(59) Referring to FIG. **2**, an illustrative network environment **200** is depicted. As shown, the network environment **200** may include one or more clients **202(1)-202(n)** (also generally referred to as local machine(s) **202** or client(s) **202**) in communication with one or more servers **204(1)-204(n)** (also generally referred to as remote machine(s) **204** or server(s) **204**) via one or more networks **206(1)-206(n)** (generally referred to as network(s) **206**). In some embodiments, a client **202** may communicate with a server **204** via one or more appliances **208(1)-208(n)** (generally referred to as appliance(s) **208** or gateway(s) **208**). In some embodiments, a client **202** may have the capacity to function as both a client node seeking access to resources provided by a

server **204** and as a server **204** providing access to hosted resources for other clients **202**.

(60) Although the embodiment shown in FIG. 2 shows one or more networks **206** between the client devices **202** and the servers **204**, in other embodiments, the client devices **202** and the servers **204** may be on the same network **206**. When multiple networks **206** are employed, the various networks **206** may be the same type of network or different types of networks. For example, in some embodiments, the networks **206(1)** and **206(n)** may be private networks such as local area network (LANs) or company Intranets, while the network **206(2)** may be a public network, such as a metropolitan area network (MAN), wide area network (WAN), or the Internet. In other embodiments, one or both of the network **206(1)** and the network **206(n)**, as well as the network **206(2)**, may be public networks. In yet other embodiments, all three of the network **206(1)**, the network **206(2)** and the network **206(n)** may be private networks. The networks **206** may employ one or more types of physical networks and/or network topologies, such as wired and/or wireless networks, and may employ one or more communication transport protocols, such as transmission control protocol (TCP), internet protocol (IP), user datagram protocol (UDP) or other similar protocols. In some embodiments, the network(s) **206** may include one or more mobile telephone networks that use various protocols to communicate among mobile devices. In some embodiments, the network(s) **206** may include one or more wireless local-area networks (WLANs). For short range communications within a WLAN, clients **202** may communicate using 802.11, Bluetooth, and/or Near Field Communication (NFC).

(61) As shown in FIG. 2, one or more appliances **208** may be located at various points or in various communication paths of the network environment **200**. For example, the appliance **208(1)** may be deployed between the network **206(1)** and the network **206(2)**, and the appliance **208(n)** may be deployed between the network **206(2)** and the network **206(n)**. In some embodiments, the appliances **208** may communicate with one another and work in conjunction to, for example, accelerate network traffic between the clients **202** and the servers **204**. In some embodiments, appliances **208** may act as a gateway between two or more networks. In other embodiments, one or more of the appliances **208** may instead be implemented in conjunction with or as part of a single one of the clients **202** or servers **204** to allow such device to connect directly to one of the networks **206**. In some embodiments, one or more appliances **208** may operate as an application delivery controller (ADC) to provide one or more of the clients **202** with access to business applications and other data deployed in a datacenter, the cloud, or delivered as Software as a Service (SaaS) across a range of client devices, and/or provide other functionality such as load balancing, etc. In some embodiments, one or more of the appliances **208** may be implemented as network devices sold by Citrix Systems, Inc., of Fort Lauderdale, FL, such as Citrix Gateway™ or Citrix ADC™.

(62) A server **204** may be any server type such as, for example: a file server; an application server; a web server; a proxy server; an appliance; a network appliance; a gateway; an application gateway; a gateway server; a virtualization server; a deployment server; a Secure Sockets Layer Virtual Private Network (SSL VPN) server; a firewall; a web server; a server executing an active directory; a cloud server; or a server executing an application acceleration program that provides firewall functionality, application functionality, or load balancing functionality.

(63) A server **204** may execute, operate or otherwise provide an application that may be any one of the following: software; a program; executable instructions; a virtual machine; a hypervisor; a web browser; a web-based client; a client-server application; a thin-client computing client; an ActiveX control; a Java applet; software related to voice over internet protocol (VoIP) communications like a soft IP telephone; an application for streaming video and/or audio; an application for facilitating real-time-data communications; a HTTP client; a FTP client; an Oscar client; a Telnet client; or any other set of executable instructions.

(64) In some embodiments, a server **204** may execute a remote presentation services program or other program that uses a thin-client or a remote-display protocol to capture display output generated by an application executing on a server **204** and transmit the application display output to

a client device **202**.

(65) In yet other embodiments, a server **204** may execute a virtual machine providing, to a user of a client **202**, access to a computing environment. The client **202** may be a virtual machine. The virtual machine may be managed by, for example, a hypervisor, a virtual machine manager (VMM), or any other hardware virtualization technique within the server **204**.

(66) As shown in FIG. 2, in some embodiments, groups of the servers **204** may operate as one or more server farms **210**. The servers **204** of such server farms **210** may be logically grouped, and may either be geographically co-located (e.g., on premises) or geographically dispersed (e.g., cloud based) from the clients **202** and/or other servers **204**. In some embodiments, two or more server farms **210** may communicate with one another, e.g., via respective appliances **208** connected to the network **206(2)**, to allow multiple server-based processes to interact with one another.

(67) As also shown in FIG. 2, in some embodiments, one or more of the appliances **208** may include, be replaced by, or be in communication with, one or more additional appliances, such as WAN optimization appliances **212(1)-212(n)**, referred to generally as WAN optimization appliance(s) **212**. For example, WAN optimization appliances **212** may accelerate, cache, compress or otherwise optimize or improve performance, operation, flow control, or quality of service of network traffic, such as traffic to and/or from a WAN connection, such as optimizing Wide Area File Services (WAFS), accelerating Server Message Block (SMB) or Common Internet File System (CIFS). In some embodiments, one or more of the appliances **212** may be a performance enhancing proxy or a WAN optimization controller.

(68) In some embodiments, one or more of the appliances **208**, **212** may be implemented as products sold by Citrix Systems, Inc., of Fort Lauderdale, FL, such as Citrix SD-WAN™ or Citrix Cloud™. For example, in some implementations, one or more of the appliances **208**, **212** may be cloud connectors that enable communications to be exchanged between resources within a cloud computing environment and resources outside such an environment, e.g., resources hosted within a data center of an organization.

(69) C. Computing Environment

(70) FIG. 3 illustrates an example of a computing system **300** that may be used to implement one or more of the respective components (e.g., the clients **202**, the servers **204**, the appliances **208**, **212**) within the network environment **200** shown in FIG. 2. As shown in FIG. 3, the computing system **300** may include one or more processors **302**, volatile memory **304** (e.g., RAM), non-volatile memory **306** (e.g., one or more hard disk drives (HDDs) or other magnetic or optical storage media, one or more solid state drives (SSDs) such as a flash drive or other solid state storage media, one or more hybrid magnetic and solid state drives, and/or one or more virtual storage volumes, such as a cloud storage, or a combination of such physical storage volumes and virtual storage volumes or arrays thereof), a user interface (UI) **308**, one or more communications interfaces **310**, and a communication bus **312**. The user interface **308** may include a graphical user interface (GUI) **314** (e.g., a touchscreen, a display, etc.) and one or more input/output (I/O) devices **316** (e.g., a mouse, a keyboard, etc.). The non-volatile memory **306** may store an operating system **318**, one or more applications **320**, and data **322** such that, for example, computer instructions of the operating system **318** and/or applications **320** are executed by the processor(s) **302** out of the volatile memory **304**. Data may be entered using an input device of the GUI **314** or received from I/O device(s) **316**. Various elements of the computing system **300** may communicate via communication the bus **312**. The computing system **300** as shown in FIG. 3 is shown merely as an example, as the clients **202**, servers **204** and/or appliances **208** and **212** may be implemented by any computing or processing environment and with any type of machine or set of machines that may have suitable hardware and/or software capable of operating as described herein.

(71) The processor(s) **302** may be implemented by one or more programmable processors executing one or more computer programs to perform the functions of the system. As used herein, the term “processor” describes an electronic circuit that performs a function, an operation, or a

sequence of operations. The function, operation, or sequence of operations may be hard coded into the electronic circuit or soft coded by way of instructions held in a memory device. A “processor” may perform the function, operation, or sequence of operations using digital values or using analog signals. In some embodiments, the “processor” can be embodied in one or more application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), microprocessors, digital signal processors, microcontrollers, field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), programmable logic arrays (PLAs), multi-core processors, or general-purpose computers with associated memory. The “processor” may be analog, digital or mixed-signal. In some embodiments, the “processor” may be one or more physical processors or one or more “virtual” (e.g., remotely located or “cloud”) processors.

(72) The communications interfaces **310** may include one or more interfaces to enable the computing system **300** to access a computer network such as a Local Area Network (LAN), a Wide Area Network (WAN), a Personal Area Network (PAN), or the Internet through a variety of wired and/or wireless connections, including cellular connections.

(73) As noted above, in some embodiments, one or more computing systems **300** may execute an application on behalf of a user of a client computing device (e.g., a client **202** shown in FIG. 2), may execute a virtual machine, which provides an execution session within which applications execute on behalf of a user or a client computing device (e.g., a client **202** shown in FIG. 2), such as a hosted desktop session, may execute a terminal services session to provide a hosted desktop environment, or may provide access to a computing environment including one or more of: one or more applications, one or more desktop applications, and one or more desktop sessions in which one or more applications may execute.

(74) D. Systems and Methods for Delivering Shared Resources Using a Cloud Computing Environment

(75) Referring to FIG. 4, a cloud computing environment **400** is depicted, which may also be referred to as a cloud environment, cloud computing or cloud network. The cloud computing environment **400** can provide the delivery of shared computing services and/or resources to multiple users or tenants. For example, the shared resources and services can include, but are not limited to, networks, network bandwidth, servers, processing, memory, storage, applications, virtual machines, databases, software, hardware, analytics, and intelligence.

(76) In the cloud computing environment **400**, one or more clients **202** (such as those described in connection with FIG. 2) are in communication with a cloud network **404**. The cloud network **404** may include back-end platforms, e.g., servers, storage, server farms and/or data centers. The clients **202** may correspond to a single organization/tenant or multiple organizations/tenants. More particularly, in one example implementation, the cloud computing environment **400** may provide a private cloud serving a single organization (e.g., enterprise cloud). In another example, the cloud computing environment **400** may provide a community or public cloud serving multiple organizations/tenants.

(77) In some embodiments, a gateway appliance(s) or service may be utilized to provide access to cloud computing resources and virtual sessions. By way of example, Citrix Gateway, provided by Citrix Systems, Inc., may be deployed on-premises or on public clouds to provide users with secure access and single sign-on to virtual, SaaS and web applications. Furthermore, to protect users from web threats, a gateway such as Citrix Secure Web Gateway may be used. Citrix Secure Web Gateway uses a cloud-based service and a local cache to check for URL reputation and category.

(78) In still further embodiments, the cloud computing environment **400** may provide a hybrid cloud that is a combination of a public cloud and one or more resources located outside such a cloud, such as resources hosted within one or more data centers of an organization. Public clouds may include public servers that are maintained by third parties to the clients **202** or the enterprise/tenant. The servers may be located off-site in remote geographical locations or otherwise. In some implementations, one or more cloud connectors may be used to facilitate the exchange of communications between one more resources within the cloud computing environment

400 and one or more resources outside of such an environment.

(79) The cloud computing environment **400** can provide resource pooling to serve multiple users via clients **202** through a multi-tenant environment or multi-tenant model with different physical and virtual resources dynamically assigned and reassigned responsive to different demands within the respective environment. The multi-tenant environment can include a system or architecture that can provide a single instance of software, an application or a software application to serve multiple users. In some embodiments, the cloud computing environment **400** can provide on-demand self-service to unilaterally provision computing capabilities (e.g., server time, network storage) across a network for multiple clients **202**. By way of example, provisioning services may be provided through a system such as Citrix Provisioning Services (Citrix PVS). Citrix PVS is a software-streaming technology that delivers patches, updates, and other configuration information to multiple virtual desktop endpoints through a shared desktop image. The cloud computing environment **400** can provide an elasticity to dynamically scale out or scale in response to different demands from one or more clients **202**. In some embodiments, the cloud computing environment **400** may include or provide monitoring services to monitor, control and/or generate reports corresponding to the provided shared services and resources.

(80) In some embodiments, the cloud computing environment **400** may provide cloud-based delivery of different types of cloud computing services, such as Software as a service (SaaS) **402**, Platform as a Service (PaaS) **404**, Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS) **406**, and Desktop as a Service (DaaS) **408**, for example. IaaS may refer to a user renting the use of infrastructure resources that are needed during a specified time period. IaaS providers may offer storage, networking, servers or virtualization resources from large pools, allowing the users to quickly scale up by accessing more resources as needed. Examples of IaaS include AMAZON WEB SERVICES provided by Amazon.com, Inc., of Seattle, Washington, RACKSPACE CLOUD provided by Rackspace US, Inc., of San Antonio, Texas, Google Compute Engine provided by Google Inc. of Mountain View, California, or RIGHTSCALE provided by RightScale, Inc., of Santa Barbara, California.

(81) PaaS providers may offer functionality provided by IaaS, including, e.g., storage, networking, servers or virtualization, as well as additional resources such as, e.g., the operating system, middleware, or runtime resources. Examples of PaaS include WINDOWS AZURE provided by Microsoft Corporation of Redmond, Washington, Google App Engine provided by Google Inc., and HEROKU provided by Heroku, Inc. of San Francisco, California.

(82) SaaS providers may offer the resources that PaaS provides, including storage, networking, servers, virtualization, operating system, middleware, or runtime resources. In some embodiments, SaaS providers may offer additional resources including, e.g., data and application resources. Examples of SaaS include GOOGLE APPS provided by Google Inc., SALESFORCE provided by Salesforce.com Inc. of San Francisco, California, or OFFICE 365 provided by Microsoft Corporation. Examples of SaaS may also include data storage providers, e.g. Citrix ShareFile® from Citrix Systems, DROPBOX provided by Dropbox, Inc. of San Francisco, California, Microsoft SKYDRIVE provided by Microsoft Corporation, Google Drive provided by Google Inc., or Apple ICLOUD provided by Apple Inc. of Cupertino, California.

(83) Similar to SaaS, DaaS (which is also known as hosted desktop services) is a form of virtual desktop infrastructure (VDI) in which virtual desktop sessions are typically delivered as a cloud service along with the apps used on the virtual desktop. Citrix Cloud from Citrix Systems is one example of a DaaS delivery platform. DaaS delivery platforms may be hosted on a public cloud computing infrastructure, such as AZURE CLOUD from Microsoft Corporation of Redmond, Washington, or AMAZON WEB SERVICES provided by Amazon.com, Inc., of Seattle, Washington, for example. In the case of Citrix Cloud, Citrix Workspace app may be used as a single-entry point for bringing apps, files and desktops together (whether on-premises or in the cloud) to deliver a unified experience.

(84) E. Systems and Methods for Providing File Sharing Over Network(s)

(85) FIG. 5A shows an example network environment **500** for allowing an authorized client **202a** and/or an unauthorized client **202b** to upload a file **502** to a file sharing system **504** or download a file **502** from the file sharing system **504**. The authorized client **202a** may, for example, be a client **202** operated by a user having an active account with the file sharing system **504**, while the unauthorized client **202b** may be operated by a user who lacks such an account. As shown, in some embodiments, the authorized client **202a** may include a file management application **513** with which a user of the authorized client **202a** may access and/or manage the accessibility of one or more files **502** via the file sharing system **504**. The file management application **513** may, for example, be a mobile or desktop application installed on the authorized client **202a** (or in a computing environment accessible by the authorized client). The ShareFile® mobile app and the ShareFile® desktop app offered by Citrix Systems, Inc., of Fort Lauderdale, FL, are examples of such preinstalled applications. In other embodiments, rather than being installed on the authorized client **202a**, the file management application **513** may be executed by a web server (included with the file sharing system **504** or elsewhere) and provided to the authorized client **202a** via one or more web pages.

(86) As FIG. 5A illustrates, in some embodiments, the file sharing system **504** may include an access management system **506** and a storage system **508**. As shown, the access management system **506** may include one or more access management servers **204a** and a database **510**, and the storage system **508** may include one or more storage control servers **204b** and a storage medium(s) **512**. In some embodiments, the access management server(s) **204a** may, for example, allow a user of the file management application **513** to log in to his or her account, e.g., by entering a user name and password corresponding to account data stored in the database **510**. Once the user of the client **202a** has logged in, the access management server **204a** may enable the user to view (via the authorized client **202a**) information identifying various folders represented in the storage medium(s) **512**, which is managed by the storage control server(s) **204b**, as well as any files **502** contained within such folders. File/folder metadata stored in the database **510** may be used to identify the files **502** and folders in the storage medium(s) **512** to which a particular user has been provided access rights.

(87) In some embodiments, the clients **202a**, **202b** may be connected to one or more networks **206a** (which may include the Internet), the access management server(s) **204a** may include web servers, and an appliance **208a** may load balance requests from the authorized client **202a** to such web servers. The database **510** associated with the access management server(s) **204a** may, for example, include information used to process user requests, such as user account data (e.g., username, password, access rights, security questions and answers, etc.), file and folder metadata (e.g., name, description, storage location, access rights, source IP address, etc.), and logs, among other things. Although the clients **202a**, **202b** are shown in FIG. 5A as stand-alone computers, it should be appreciated that one or both of the clients **202a**, **202b** shown in FIG. 5A may instead represent other types of computing devices or systems that can be operated by users. In some embodiments, for example, one or both of the authorized client **202a** and the unauthorized client **202b** may be implemented as a server-based virtual computing environment that can be remotely accessed using a separate computing device operated by users, such as described above.

(88) In some embodiments, the access management system **506** may be logically separated from the storage system **508**, such that files **502** and other data that are transferred between clients **202** and the storage system **508** do not pass through the access management system **506**. Similar to the access management server(s) **204a**, one or more appliances **208b** may load-balance requests from the clients **202a**, **202b** received from the network(s) **206a** (which may include the Internet) to the storage control server(s) **204b**. In some embodiments, the storage control server(s) **204b** and/or the storage medium(s) **512** may be hosted by a cloud-based service provider (e.g., Amazon Web Services™ or Microsoft Azure™). In other embodiments, the storage control server(s) **204b** and/or the storage medium(s) **512** may be located at a data center managed by an enterprise of a client

202, or may be distributed among some combination of a cloud-based system and an enterprise system, or elsewhere.

(89) After a user of the authorized client **202a** has properly logged in to an access management server **204a**, the server **204a** may receive a request from the client **202a** for access to one of the files **502** or folders to which the logged in user has access rights. The request may either be for the authorized client **202a** to itself to obtain access to a file **502** or folder or to provide such access to the unauthorized client **202b**. In some embodiments, in response to receiving an access request from an authorized client **202a**, the access management server **204a** may communicate with the storage control server(s) **204b** (e.g., either over the Internet via appliances **208a** and **208b** or via an appliance **208c** positioned between networks **206b** and **206c**) to obtain a token generated by the storage control server **204b** that can subsequently be used to access the identified file **502** or folder.

(90) In some implementations, the generated token may, for example, be sent to the authorized client **202a**, and the authorized client **202a** may then send a request for a file **502**, including the token, to the storage control server(s) **204b**. In other implementations, the authorized client **202a** may send the generated token to the unauthorized client **202b** so as to allow the unauthorized client **202b** to send a request for the file **502**, including the token, to the storage control server(s) **204b**. In yet other implementations, an access management server **204a** may, at the direction of the authorized client **202a**, send the generated token directly to the unauthorized client **202b** so as to allow the unauthorized client **202b** to send a request for the file **502**, including the token, to the storage control server(s) **204b**. In any of the forgoing scenarios, the request sent to the storage control server(s) **204b** may, in some embodiments, include a uniform resource locator (URL) that resolves to an internet protocol (IP) address of the storage control server(s) **204b**, and the token may be appended to or otherwise accompany the URL. Accordingly, providing access to one or more clients **202** may be accomplished, for example, by causing the authorized client **202a** to send a request to the URL address, or by sending an email, text message or other communication including the token-containing URL to the unauthorized client **202b**, either directly from the access management server(s) **204a** or indirectly from the access management server(s) **204a** to the authorized client **202a** and then from the authorized client **202a** to the unauthorized client **202b**. In some embodiments, selecting the URL or a user interface element corresponding to the URL, may cause a request to be sent to the storage control server(s) **204b** that either causes a file **502** to be downloaded immediately to the client that sent the request, or may cause the storage control server **204b** to return a webpage to the client that includes a link or other user interface element that can be selected to effect the download.

(91) In some embodiments, a generated token can be used in a similar manner to allow either an authorized client **202a** or an unauthorized client **202b** to upload a file **502** to a folder corresponding to the token. In some embodiments, for example, an “upload” token can be generated as discussed above when an authorized client **202a** is logged in and a designated folder is selected for uploading. Such a selection may, for example, cause a request to be sent to the access management server(s) **204a**, and a webpage may be returned, along with the generated token, that permits the user to drag and drop one or more files **502** into a designated region and then select a user interface element to effect the upload. The resulting communication to the storage control server(s) **204b** may include both the to-be-uploaded file(s) **502** and the pertinent token. On receipt of the communication, a storage control server **204b** may cause the file(s) **502** to be stored in a folder corresponding to the token.

(92) In some embodiments, sending a request including such a token to the storage control server(s) **204b** (e.g., by selecting a URL or user-interface element included in an email inviting the user to upload one or more files **502** to the file sharing system **504**), a webpage may be returned that permits the user to drag and drop one or more files **502** into a designated region and then select a user interface element to effect the upload. The resulting communication to the storage control server(s) **204b** may include both the to-be-uploaded file(s) **502** and the pertinent token. On receipt

of the communication, a storage control server **204b** may cause the file(s) **502** to be stored in a folder corresponding to the token.

(93) In the described embodiments, the clients **202**, servers **204**, and appliances **208** and/or **212** (appliances **212** are shown in FIG. 2) may be deployed as and/or executed on any type and form of computing device, such as any desktop computer, laptop computer, rack-mounted computer, or mobile device capable of communication over at least one network and performing the operations described herein. For example, the clients **202**, servers **204** and/or appliances **208** and/or **212** may correspond to respective computing systems, groups of computing systems, or networks of distributed computing systems, such as computing system **300** shown in FIG. 3.

(94) As discussed above in connection with FIG. 5A, in some embodiments, a file sharing system may be distributed between two sub-systems, with one subsystem (e.g., the access management system **506**) being responsible for controlling access to files **502** stored in the other subsystem (e.g., the storage system **508**). FIG. 5B illustrates conceptually how one or more clients **202** may interact with two such subsystems.

(95) As shown in FIG. 5B, an authorized user operating a client **202**, which may take on any of numerous forms, may log in to the access management system **506**, for example, by entering a valid user name and password. In some embodiments, the access management system **506** may include one or more web servers that respond to requests from the client **202**. The access management system **506** may store metadata concerning the identity and arrangements of files **502** (shown in FIG. 5A) stored by the storage system **508**, such as folders maintained by the storage system **508** and any files **502** contained within such folders. In some embodiments, the metadata may also include permission metadata identifying the folders and files **502** that respective users are allowed to access. Once logged in, a user may employ a user-interface mechanism of the client **202** to navigate among folders for which the metadata indicates the user has access permission.

(96) In some embodiments, the logged-in user may select a particular file **502** the user wants to access and/or to which the logged-in user wants a different user of a different client **202** to be able to access. Upon receiving such a selection from a client **202**, the access management system **506** may take steps to authorize access to the selected file **502** by the logged-in client **202** and/or the different client **202**. In some embodiments, for example, the access management system **506** may interact with the storage system **508** to obtain a unique “download” token which may subsequently be used by a client **202** to retrieve the identified file **502** from the storage system **508**. The access management system **506** may, for example, send the download token to the logged-in client **202** and/or a client **202** operated by a different user. In some embodiments, the download token may be a single-use token that expires after its first use.

(97) In some embodiments, the storage system **508** may also include one or more web servers and may respond to requests from clients **202**. In such embodiments, one or more files **502** may be transferred from the storage system **508** to a client **202** in response to a request that includes the download token. In some embodiments, for example, the download token may be appended to a URL that resolves to an IP address of the web server(s) of the storage system **508**. Access to a given file **502** may thus, for example, be enabled by a “download link” that includes the URL/token. Such a download link may, for example, be sent to the logged-in client **202** in the form of a “DOWNLOAD” button or other user-interface element the user can select to effect the transfer of the file **502** from the storage system **508** to the client **202**. Alternatively, the download link may be sent to a different client **202** operated by an individual with which the logged-in user desires to share the file **502**. For example, in some embodiments, the access management system **506** may send an email or other message to the different client **202** that includes the download link in the form of a “DOWNLOAD” button or other user-interface element, or simply with a message indicating “Click Here to Download” or the like. In yet other embodiments, the logged-in client **202** may receive the download link from the access management system **506** and cut-and-paste or otherwise copy the download link into an email or other message the logged in user can then send

to the other client **202** to enable the other client **202** to retrieve the file **502** from the storage system **508**.

(98) In some embodiments, a logged-in user may select a folder on the file sharing system to which the user wants to transfer one or more files **502** (shown in FIG. 5A) from the logged-in client **202**, or to which the logged-in user wants to allow a different user of a different client **202** to transfer one or more files **502**. Additionally or alternatively, the logged-in user may identify one or more different users (e.g., by entering their email addresses) the logged-in user wants to be able to access one or more files **502** currently accessible to the logged-in client **202**.

(99) Similar to the file downloading process described above, upon receiving such a selection from a client **202**, the access management system **506** may take steps to authorize access to the selected folder by the logged-in client **202** and/or the different client **202**. In some embodiments, for example, the access management system **506** may interact with the storage system **508** to obtain a unique “upload token” which may subsequently be used by a client **202** to transfer one or more files **502** from the client **202** to the storage system **508**. The access management system **506** may, for example, send the upload token to the logged-in client **202** and/or a client **202** operated by a different user.

(100) One or more files **502** may be transferred from a client **202** to the storage system **508** in response to a request that includes the upload token. In some embodiments, for example, the upload token may be appended to a URL that resolves to an IP address of the webserver(s) of the storage system **508**. For example, in some embodiments, in response to a logged-in user selecting a folder to which the user desires to transfer one or more files **502** and/or identifying one or more intended recipients of such files **502**, the access management system **506** may return a webpage requesting that the user drag-and-drop or otherwise identify the file(s) **502** the user desires to transfer to the selected folder and/or a designated recipient. The returned webpage may also include an “upload link,” e.g., in the form of an “UPLOAD” button or other user-interface element that the user can select to effect the transfer of the file(s) **502** from the client **202** to the storage system **508**.

(101) In some embodiments, in response to a logged-in user selecting a folder to which the user wants to enable a different client **202** operated by a different user to transfer one or more files **502**, the access management system **506** may generate an upload link that may be sent to the different client **202**. For example, in some embodiments, the access management system **506** may send an email or other message to the different client **202** that includes a message indicating that the different user has been authorized to transfer one or more files **502** to the file sharing system, and inviting the user to select the upload link to effect such a transfer. Selection of the upload link by the different user may, for example, generate a request to webserver(s) in the storage system and cause a webserver to return a webpage inviting the different user to drag-and-drop or otherwise identify the file(s) **502** the different user wishes to upload to the file sharing system **504**. The returned webpage may also include a user-interface element, e.g., in the form of an “UPLOAD” button, that the different user can select to effect the transfer of the file(s) **502** from the client **202** to the storage system **508**. In other embodiments, the logged-in user may receive the upload link from the access management system **506** and may cut-and-paste or otherwise copy the upload link into an email or other message the logged-in user can then send to the different client **202** to enable the different client to upload one or more files **502** to the storage system **508**.

(102) In some embodiments, in response to one or more files **502** being uploaded to a folder, the storage system **508** may send a message to the access management system **506** indicating that the file(s) **502** have been successfully uploaded, and an access management system **506** may, in turn, send an email or other message to one or more users indicating the same. For user's that have accounts with the file sharing system **504**, for example, a message may be sent to the account holder that includes a download link that the account holder can select to effect the transfer of the file **502** from the storage system **508** to the client **202** operated by the account holder. Alternatively, the message to the account holder may include a link to a webpage from the access management

system **506** inviting the account holder to log in to retrieve the transferred files **502**. Likewise, in circumstances in which a logged-in user identifies one or more intended recipients for one or more to-be-uploaded files **502** (e.g., by entering their email addresses), the access management system **506** may send a message including a download link to the designated recipients (e.g., in the manner described above), which such designated recipients can then use to effect the transfer of the file(s) **502** from the storage system **508** to the client(s) **202** operated by those designated recipients.

(103) FIG. 5C is a block diagram showing an example of a process for generating access tokens (e.g., the upload tokens and download tokens discussed above) within the file sharing system **504** described in connection with FIGS. 5A and 5B.

(104) As shown, in some embodiments, a logged-in client **202** may initiate the access token generation process by sending an access request **514** to the access management server(s) **204b**. As noted above, the access request **514** may, for example, correspond to one or more of (A) a request to enable the downloading of one or more files **502** (shown in FIG. 5A) from the storage system **508** to the logged-in client **202**, (B) a request to enable the downloading of one or more files **502** from the storage system **508** to a different client **202** operated by a different user, (C) a request to enable the uploading of one or more files **502** from a logged-in client **202** to a folder on the storage system **508**, (D) a request to enable the uploading of one or more files **502** from a different client **202** operated by a different user to a folder of the storage system **508**, (E) a request to enable the transfer of one or more files **502**, via the storage system **508**, from a logged-in client **202** to a different client **202** operated by a different user, or (F) a request to enable the transfer of one or more files **502**, via the storage system **508**, from a different client **202** operated by a different user to a logged-in client **202**.

(105) In response to receiving the access request **514**, an access management server **204a** may send a “prepare” message **516** to the storage control server(s) **204b** of the storage system **508**, identifying the type of action indicated in the request, as well as the identity and/or location within the storage medium(s) **512** of any applicable folders and/or files **502**. As shown, in some embodiments, a trust relationship may be established (step **518**) between the storage control server(s) **204b** and the access management server(s) **204a**. In some embodiments, for example, the storage control server(s) **204b** may establish the trust relationship by validating a hash-based message authentication code (HMAC) based on shared secret or key **530**.

(106) After the trust relationship has been established, the storage control server(s) **204b** may generate and send (step **520**) to the access management server(s) **204a** a unique upload token and/or a unique download token, such as those as discussed above.

(107) After the access management server(s) **204a** receive a token from the storage control server(s) **204b**, the access management server(s) **204a** may prepare and send a link **522** including the token to one or more client(s) **202**. In some embodiments, for example, the link may contain a fully qualified domain name (FQDN) of the storage control server(s) **204b**, together with the token. As discussed above, the link **522** may be sent to the logged-in client **202** and/or to a different client **202** operated by a different user, depending on the operation that was indicated by the request.

(108) The client(s) **202** that receive the token may thereafter send a request **524** (which includes the token) to the storage control server(s) **204b**. In response to receiving the request, the storage control server(s) **204b** may validate (step **526**) the token and, if the validation is successful, the storage control server(s) **204b** may interact with the client(s) **202** to effect the transfer (step **528**) of the pertinent file(s) **502**, as discussed above.

(109) F. Detailed Description of Example Embodiments of a System for Uploading Files Using Distributed Devices

(110) As described above (in Section A) in connection with FIGS. 1A-C, at a high level, a client device **202**, such as the first device **102**, may determine that a file (e.g., the file **108**) is to be uploaded to a computing system (e.g., the computing system **100**). As also described, in some implementations, the first device **102** may determine multiple client devices **202** are within a

physical proximity of the first device **102** and may transmit different data portions (referred to herein as “chunks”) of the file **108** to the individual client devices **202** of the multiple client devices **202**. The computing system **100** may provide access and/or connection data to the multiple client devices **202** to enable peer-to-peer sharing of the distributed data chunks amongst those client devices **202**. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may use the data chunks it receives from the multiple client device(s) **202** to reconstruct a complete copy of the file **108** and store the file **108**, such as within the storage system **508** of the file sharing system **504**.

(111) FIGS. **6A-6D** illustrate an example process for collaboratively uploading a file **108** to the computing system **100** using multiple client devices **202** (e.g., the first device **102**, the second device **104**, and a third device **602**) within a proximity of one another, in accordance with some embodiments. Although three such client devices **202** are shown in FIGS. **6A-6D**, it should be appreciated that additional or fewer client devices **202** may be employed in some circumstances. As noted above, in some embodiments, the computing system **100** may be part of the file sharing system **504** described in Section E. A user of a client device **202**, such as the first device **102**, may operate the client device **202** to request to upload the file **108** or set of files to a file server, such as the computing system **100**. The first device **102** may use a client application, such as the file management application **513** described in Section E (in connection with FIG. **5A**), to request the file upload to the computing system **100**. In some implementations, upon registration of the client application with a client device **202**, such as the first device **102**, the client application may request and obtain permission to access the Bluetooth functionalities of the client device **202**. The client application may collect device-specific information, such as a unique device identifier, the Media Access Control (MAC) address of the device, and possibly additional or different information for networking and/or communication. In some implementations, the device-specific information may be sent to the computing system **100** and stored, such as within the storage system **508** of the file sharing system **504**.

(112) As shown in FIG. **6A**, in some implementations, upon receiving the upload request, such as via the client application, the first device **102** may attempt to identify other client devices **202** within a proximity of the first device **102** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**). In some implementations, in response to receiving a user input requesting the uploading of a file, the client application may prompt the user for approval to take steps to identify other client devices **202** that are capable of participating in a collaborative uploading process for the file **108**. For example, the client application of the first device **102** may display the prompt “Identify nearby devices for collaborative uploading?” and request either a “Yes” or a “No” response. In response to the user agreeing to take such steps, e.g., by providing a “Yes” response, the client application of the first device **102** may access a short range wireless radio of the first device **102**, such as a Bluetooth or Wi-Fi transceiver, to identify one or more other devices, such as the second device **104** and the third device **602**, which may be within a physical proximity of the first device **102**. For example, as shown in FIG. **6A**, the first device **102** may detect that the second device **104** and the third device **602** are located within the same geographic region **604** or are otherwise in close enough proximity to engage in wireless communication with one another.

(113) In some implementations, the first device **102** may transmit data identifying the one or more devices detected within the proximity of the first device **102**, such as a Bluetooth name or MAC address of the one or more other devices, to the computing system **100**. In other implementations, the first device **102** may additionally or alternatively transmit the geographic location, such as GPS coordinates, of the first device **102** to the computing system **100**. In either case, the data may be transmitted to the computing system **100**. In some implementations, such data concerning individual client devices **202** may be encrypted before it is sent to the computing system **100**.

(114) Referring to FIG. **6B**, in some implementations, upon receipt of the data identifying the one or more client devices **202** detected within the proximity of the first device **102**, the computing system **100** may identify a subset of the one or more client devices **202** which have provided

consent to participate in collaborative uploads. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may transmit a request for consent to participate in the collaborative upload to the one or more client devices **202** detected within the proximity of the first device **102**. Upon receipt of the request, in some implementations, the client application of the respective client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**) may present a query for consent to participate. For example, the client application of the second device **104** may display the prompt “Participate in a collaborative upload?” and request either a “Yes” or a “No” response. In response to the user providing a response, the client application of the second device **104** may instruct the second device **104** to transmit the consent response to the computing system **100**. In some implementations, one or more of the client devices **202** (e.g., the first device **102**, the second device **104**, and the third device **602**) may provide participation consent beforehand, such as by identifying devices, users, groups of devices, or groups of users with which an individual client device **202** prospectively consents to participate in collaborative uploads. In such implementations, the computing system **100** need not transmit consent requests to the individual client devices **202** which have provided such prospective consent.

(115) In some implementations, based upon the received participation consent and/or the previously provided consent, the computing system **100** may determine a subset of the nearby client devices **202** that are to participate in the collaborative uploading of the file **108** from the first device to the computing system **100**. The computing system **100** may make such a determination in any of a number of ways. For example, in some implementations, the first device **102** may transmit data identifying the second device **104** and the third device **602** as being within a proximity of the first device **102**. The computing system **100** may then identify second device **104** and/or the third device **602** as having provided consent to participate in a collaborative upload. The computing system **100** may transmit data back to the first device **102** identifying the second device **104** and/or the third device **602** as being within the subset of client devices **202** that are to participate in the collaborative upload. This group and/or subset of client devices **202** may be referred to as a “proximity group.” In some implementations, the computing system **100** may transmit data identifying the individual client devices **202** in the determined proximity group to the first device **102**.

(116) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may additionally transmit to the first device **102** data identifying the number of client devices **202** in the determined proximity group. In some implementations, the client device **202** from the subset of client devices **202**, or proximity group, that requested the file upload (e.g., the first device **102**), may be identified as the “host” device. In some implementations, based upon the number of client devices **202** in the proximity group, the host device may divide the file **108** into file chunks, such as the file portions **606a**, **606b**, and **606c** shown in FIG. **6B**. In some implementations, the file portions **606** may be individually encrypted by the host device. In other implementations, the entirety of the file **108** may be encrypted by the host device prior to being divided into multiple chunks. In either case, the computing system **100** may provide the host device with a key (e.g., a public key) for encrypting the file **108** or the respective file portions **606a**, **606b**, and **606c**.

(117) As shown in FIG. **6C**, in some implementations, the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) may send respective file portions (e.g., the file portions **606b** and **606c**) to the non-host client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**) within the proximity group.

(118) In some implementations, to facilitate such sharing of the file portions **606** amongst the client devices **202**, the computing system **100** may provide instructions to the client applications of the client devices **202** in the proximity group to establish one or more wireless communications links (e.g., via one or more wireless peer-to-peer connections) amongst those client devices **202**. For example, as described in more detail below, the computing system **100** may send instructions to the client application of the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) to create a Wi-Fi hotspot and may send instructions to the client applications of the non-host client device(s) **202** (e.g., the second

device **104** and the third device **602**) to connect to that Wi-Fi hotspot. In response to the one or more non-host client devices **202** of the proximity group (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**) receiving the connection instructions, the client application(s) of those non-host client device(s) **202** may establish connections with the host device (e.g., the first device **102**), such as by connecting to the Wi-Fi hotspot created by the host device.

(119) After establishing a connection with the non-host client device(s) **202** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**), such as via a Wi-Fi Hotspot, the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) may transmit respective file chunks **606** to the non-host client device(s) **202**. For example, as illustrated in FIG. 6C, the first device **102** may transmit the second file portion **606b** to the second device **104** and may transmit the third file portion **606c** to the third device **602**. In some implementations, upon confirmation of a successful transmittal of the file portions **606** to the non-host client device(s) **202**, the host device may terminate the wireless communication links, such as by disabling the Wi-Fi hotspot.

(120) As shown in FIG. 6D, in some implementations, the proximity group (e.g., the first device **102**, the second device **104**, and the third device **602**) may send their respective file portions **606** to the computing system **100**. For example, the first device **102** may send the first file portion **606a**, the second device **104** may send the second file portion **606b**, and the third device **602** may send the third file portion **606c**. After the computing system **100** has received the file portions **606** from the proximity group, the computing system **100** may merge the different file chunks (e.g., the first file portion **606a**, the second file portion **606b**, and the third file portion **606c**) to reconstruct the file **108**. In some implementations, the received file portions **606** may be individually decrypted by the computing system **100** (e.g., using a private key corresponding to the public key that was used to encrypt the respective file portions **606**) prior to merging them to generate the reconstructed file. In other implementations, the file **108** may be decrypted by the computing system **100** (e.g., using a private key corresponding to the public key that was used to encrypt the entire file **108** before it was divided into the file portions **606**) after the file portions **606** have been merged to reconstruct the encrypted version of the file **108**. In some implementations, the reconstructed file **108** may be stored at the computing system **100**.

(121) FIG. 7A illustrates an example routine **700** that may be performed by a client application requesting an upload of a file or data object using collaborative uploading, in accordance with some embodiments. In some implementations, a user may operate a client device **202** (e.g., the first device **102**) to request an upload of a file from the user's client device **202** through a client application, such as the file management application **513** described in Section E (in connection with FIG. 5A). In some implementations, the client application may include a graphical user interface (GUI) providing navigation tools to identify a file on the client device **202** and request to upload the file, such as to the computing system **100**.

(122) As shown in FIG. 7A, in some implementations, the routine **700** may begin at a step **702**, at which the client application may receive user input requesting to upload a file (e.g., the file **108**), such as via the GUI of the client application. In response to receiving the user input requesting to upload the file, the routine **700** may proceed to a step **704**, at which the client application may cause the client device **202** to output a prompt to the user, via the client application, for permission to begin a collaborative uploading process to upload the file to the computing system **100**. As noted above, in some implementations, the client application may, for example, cause the client device **202** to display the prompt "Identify nearby devices for collaborative uploading?" and request either a "Yes" or a "No" response.

(123) At a decision **706**, the routine **700** may continue based on the permission indicator received from the user in response to the prompt. In some implementations, if the user does not grant permission to begin the collaborative uploading process, then, at a step **708**, the client application may send a request to upload the entire file, as well the entirety of the file, to the computing system **100**, e.g., the file sharing system **504**. In such case, upon completion of the upload (as described

below reference to FIG. 7B), the computing system **100** may send a notification of the completed file upload to client device **202** (e.g., per the step **756** of the routine **750** described below in connection with FIG. 7B) and, at a step **710** of the routine **700**, the client application may receive the completed file upload notification.

(124) In some implementations, if (per the decision **706**) the client application determines that the user has granted permission to begin the collaborative uploading process, then, at a step **712** of the routine **700**, the client application may direct the client device **202** to detect one or more client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**) within a proximity of the client device **202** (e.g., the first device **102**). In some implementations, the detection of one or more client devices **202** within a proximity of one another may be performed using short range wireless radio, such as a Bluetooth or Wi-Fi transceiver.

(125) At a decision **714**, the routine **700** may continue based on the number of other client devices **202** detected within a proximity of the client device **202**. If the client device **202** does not detect any other devices within its proximity, then the client application may determine that it is not possible for the file to be uploaded using collaborative uploading. In some implementations, if no other client devices **202** are within a proximity, the routine **700** may proceed to the step **708**, and the client application may send a request to upload the entire file, as well as the entirety of the file, to the computing system **100**, e.g., the file sharing system **504**. As described above, in such case, upon completion of the upload (as described below reference to FIG. 7B), the computing system **100** may send a notification of the completed file upload to client device **202** (e.g., per the step **756** of the routine **750** described below in connection with FIG. 7B) and, at a step **710** of the routine **700**, the client application may receive the completed file upload notification.

(126) In some implementations, if (per the decision **714**) the client application determines that at least one other client device **202** was detected within a proximity of the client device **202**, then, at a step **716**, the client application may direct the client device **202** to send an upload request to the computing system **100**, including indicator(s) of the other client device(s) **202** detected within a proximity of the client device **202** (per the step **712**). As described below, the computing system **100** may use such indicators to determine a proximity group for the client device **202**.

(127) In some implementations, at a step **718**, the client application may receive an indication of the determined proximity group, e.g., identifiers of the other client devices **202** and/or users operating such devices, from the computing system **100** (e.g., per the step **762** of the routine **750** shown in FIG. 7B). In some implementations, at a step **720**, the client application may encrypt the file to be uploaded, such as with a public key provided by the computing system **100**. Further, at the step **720**, the client application may additionally divide the file into file portions based on the number of client devices **202** in the determined proximity group.

(128) In some implementations, at a step **722** of the routine **700**, the client application may receive information from the computing system **100** (e.g., per the step **764** of the routine **750** shown in FIG. 7B) for establishing and/or activating one or more communications links between the client device **202** and the other client devices **202** within the proximity group. For example, the computing system **100** may provide instructions to the client application for establishing a Wi-Fi hotspot, with such instructions indicating information such as the Wi-Fi hotspot name, a service set identifier (SSID) for the Wi-Fi hotspot, and a password for connecting to the Wi-Fi hotspot.

(129) In some implementations, upon establishing and/or activating the one or more communications links between the client device **202** and the other client devices **202** within the proximity group, at a step **724**, the client application may send respective file portions to individual ones of the other client devices **202** of the proximity group. Further, at a step **726**, the client application may additionally send a file portion directly to the computing system **100**. Upon receiving and merging the file portions (as described below reference to FIG. 7B), the computing system **100** may send a notification of the completed file upload to client device **202** (e.g., per the step **756** of the routine **750** described below in connection with FIG. 7B) and, at the step **710**, the

client application may receive the completed file upload notification. Further details concerning how such collaborative uploading may be accomplished in some implementations are provided below in connection with FIGS. 8A-8C.

(130) FIG. 7B illustrates an example routine **750** that may be performed by the computing system **100**, e.g., the file sharing system **504**, in conjunction with the example routine **700** (shown in FIG. 7A) that may be performed by client applications of one or more client devices **202**, in accordance with some embodiments. As shown in FIG. 7B, some implementations, the routine **750** may begin either (A) at a step **752**, at which the computing system **100** receives a request to upload an entire file **108**, as well as the entirety of the file **108**, from a client device **202**, or (B) at a step **758** (described below). As shown in FIG. 7A, the computing system **100** may receive a request to upload the entirety of a file (per the step **752**), for example, when the user does not grant permission to use the collaborative uploading process (per the step **704** of the routine **700**) or when no other devices are detected within a proximity of the client device **202** (per the step **712** of the routine **700**).

(131) In some implementations, at a step **754** of the routine **750**, the computing system **100** may store the file upon completing the upload request. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may, for example, store the file to a central repository of the file sharing system **504**, such as the storage medium(s) **512** of the storage system **508**, as shown in FIGS. 5A-C. Further, in some implementations, upon completion of the upload and storage of the file, the computing system **100**, at a step **756**, may send a notification of the completed file upload to the client device **202**. As noted above in connection with FIG. 7A, the client application of the requesting client device **202** may receive such a notification at the step **710** of the routine **700**.

(132) At the step **758** of the routine **750**, the computing system **100** may receive a request to upload the file using collaborative uploading. In some implementations, the file upload request received per the step **758** may include indicators of detected client devices **202** within a proximity of the requesting client devices **202**, such as the indicators sent by the client application at the step **716** of the routine **700** (shown in FIG. 7A).

(133) At a step **760** of the routine **750**, the computing system **100** may, in some implementations, use the indicators received from the requesting client device **202** (per the step **758**) to identify registered devices and/or request authorization from devices within the proximity to determine a set of client devices **202** that are to participate in the collaborative upload, e.g., by determining a proximity group, as described above. As noted above, in some implementations, one or more of the client devices **202** may have previously established permissions with the computing system **100**, such as providing prior authorization to participate in collaborative uploads. In some implementations, one or more client devices **202** may not have provided prior authorization, and, in such case, the computing system **100** may send a request to such client device(s) **202** to participate in the collaborative upload of the file.

(134) In some implementations, at a step **762**, an indication of the proximity group may be sent to the requesting client device **202**. As noted above in connection with FIG. 7A, the client application of the requesting client device **202** may receive such an indication at the step **718** of the routine **700**. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may send identifiers of the other client devices **202** and/or users operating such devices in the proximity group to the requesting client device **202**.

(135) At a step **764** of the routine **750**, the computing system **100** may send information to the client device **202** for establishing and/or activating one or more communications links between the client device **202** and the other client devices **202** within the proximity group. As noted above in connection with FIG. 7A, the client application of the requesting client device **202** may receive such information at the step **722** of the routine **700**. For example, the computing system **100** may provide instructions to the client application for establishing a Wi-Fi hotspot, with such instructions indicating information such as the Wi-Fi hotspot name, a service set identifier (SSID) for the Wi-Fi

hotspot, and a password for connecting to the Wi-Fi hotspot. Additionally, at a step **766**, the computing system **100** may send data for connecting to the host device to the one or more other client devices **202** in the proximity group (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**). Continuing the example of using a Wi-Fi hotspot, the one or more other client devices **202** may receive information such as the Wi-Fi hotspot name and the password for connecting to the Wi-Fi hotspot of the host device.

(136) In some implementations, at a step **768**, the computing system **100** may receive respective portions of the file from the client devices **202** within the proximity group, such as the file portions sent by the client application to the other client devices **202** (per the step **724** of the routine **700** shown in FIG. **7A**), and the file portion the client application sent directly to the computing system **100** (per the step **726** of the routine **700** shown in FIG. **7A**). At a step **770**, the computing system **100** may merge the received file portions to reconstruct a copy of the file. In some implementations, if the file is encrypted (e.g., using a public key the computing system **100** provided to the client application of the host device), then, at a step **772**, the computing system **100** may decrypt the file (e.g., using a private key corresponding to the public key provide to the host device).

(137) In some implementations, at a step **754** of the routine **750**, the computing system **100** may store the file. In some implementations, the computing system **100** may, for example, store the file to a central repository of the file sharing system **504**, such as the storage medium(s) **512** of the storage system **508**, as shown in FIGS. **5A-C**. In some implementations, upon completion of the upload and storage of the file, the computing system **100**, at a step **756** of the routine **750**, may send a notification of the completed file upload to the client device **202**. As noted above in connection with FIG. **7A**, the client application of the requesting client device **202** may receive such a notification at the step **710** of the routine **700**.

(138) FIGS. **8A-8C** illustrate an example process for a file upload through collaborative uploading based on a proximity of client devices **202**, in accordance with some embodiments. The example process illustrated in FIGS. **8A-8C** may involve three client devices **202** (e.g., the first device **102**, the second device **104**, and the third device **602**) identified as a proximity group **850** (shown in FIGS. **8A-8C**). Although three such client devices **202** (e.g., the first device **102**, the second device **104**, and the third device **602**) are shown in FIGS. **8A-8C**, it should be appreciated that additional or fewer client devices **202** may be employed in some implementations. As described above with reference to FIGS. **7A-7B**, the proximity group **850** may include client devices **202** that may have provided permission to participate in collaborative uploading and are located within a proximity of one another. The proximity may be a range in which the client devices **202** of the proximity group **850** may communicate (e.g., via one or more wireless peer-to-peer connections) with the other client devices **202** of the proximity group, such as through a Wi-Fi hotspot.

(139) As described in reference to FIG. **7A**, a client device **202** (e.g., the first device **102**) may receive (**802**) a request from a user, such as via a client application, to upload the file **108** to the computing system **100**. In some implementations, based on receiving the request, the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) may activate (**804**) a short range wireless radio, such as a Bluetooth or Wi-Fi transceiver, per instructions received from the client application. In some implementations, the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) may detect one or more client devices **202** within a proximity of the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) using the short range wireless radio.

(140) In some implementations, the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) may receive data identifying client devices **202** within a physical proximity of the host device via the short range wireless radio. Referring to FIG. **8A**, the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) may receive (**806a**) data identifying a second client device **202** (e.g., the second device **104**) and may receive (**806b**) data identifying a third client device **202** (e.g., the third device **602**). In response to receiving the proximity device data via the short range wireless radio, the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) may send (**808**) the proximity device data and the request to upload the file **108** to the computing

system **100**.

(141) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may determine whether one or the more of the identified client devices **202** are to participate in the collaborative upload. Client devices **202** may have previously established permissions with the computing system **100**, such as providing prior authorization to participate in collaborative uploads. In some implementations, a client device **202** identified in the proximity device data may not have provided prior authorization. In such cases, the computing system **100** may send (**810a**, **810b**) a request to those client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**) to participate in the collaborative upload of file **108**. The client application of the client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**) may prompt the user for permission to participate in the collaborative upload, such as previously described with reference to FIG. **6B**. In some implementations, the client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**) may send (**812a**, **812b**) the participation response to the computing system **100**.

(142) Referring to FIG. **8B**, in some implementations, based on the prior authorization and/or the received participation response, the computing system **100** may determine (**814**) the registered client devices **202** within the proximity group **850** (e.g., the first device **102**, the second device **104**, and the third device **602**). In some implementations, the computing system **100** may send (**816**) the registered proximity device data to the first device **102**. The registered proximity device data may include an indication of the number of client devices **202** in the proximity group **850**.

(143) To ensure privacy and security, in some implementations, the file portions and/or an entirety of the file **108** may be encrypted (**804**) using encryption algorithms such as Rivest-Shamir-Adleman (RSA) encryption or Triple Data Encryption Standard (DES) encryption. The computing system **100** may provide such privacy and security for the upload of the file **108** by sending (**818**) an encryption key (e.g., a public key corresponding to a private key held by the computing system **100**) to the first device **102**. Subsequently, the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) may use that key to encrypt (**820**) the file portions and/or an entirety of the file **108**. In some implementations, the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) may divide (**822**) the file **108** into file portions, referred to above as “chunks.” The number of file portions may be based on the number of client devices **202** in a proximity group **850**, as provided in the registered proximity device data received from the computing system **100**.

(144) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may send (**824**) information to the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) for establishing communications links between the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) and the other client devices **202** of the proximity group **850** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**). For example, the computing system **100** may provide instructions to the host device for establishing a Wi-Fi hotspot, with the instructions indicating information such as the Wi-Fi hotspot name, a service set identifier (SSID) for the Wi-Fi hotspot, and a password for connecting to the Wi-Fi hotspot. In some implementations, computing system **100** may send (**826a**, **826b**) data for connecting to the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) to the one or more other client devices **202** in the proximity group **850** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**). Continuing the example of using a Wi-Fi hotspot, the one or more other client devices **202** may receive information such as the Wi-Fi hotspot name and the password for connecting to the Wi-Fi hotspot of the host device.

(145) Referring next to FIG. **8C**, in some implementations, the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) may activate (**828**) a wireless connection point, such as a Wi-Fi hotspot, using the instructions provided (**824**) by the computing system **100**. The one or more other client devices **202** of the proximity group **850** may connect (**830a**, **830b**) to the wireless connection point, such as a Wi-Fi hotspot, using the data provided (**826a**, **826b**) by the computing system **100**. In response to the client devices **202** of the proximity group **850** establishing a connection with the host device (e.g., the first device **102**), the host device may send (**832a**, **832b**) respective file portions to the individual client devices **202** (e.g., the second device **104** and the third device **602**). For example,

the first device **102** may send (**832a**) “File Portion B” to the second device **104** and the first device **102** may send (**832a**) “File Portion C” to the third device **602**.

(146) In some implementations, upon receiving their respective file portions, the client devices **202** of the proximity group **850** may send (**834a**, **834b**, **834c**) those file portions to the computing system **100**. For example, the first device **102** may send (**834a**) “File Portion A” to the computing system **100**, the second device **104** may send (**834b**) “File Portion B” to the computing system **100**, and the third device **602** may send (**834c**) “File Portion C” to the computing system **100**.

(147) In some implementations, upon receiving the file portions of the file **108**, the computing system may merge (**836**) the file portions (e.g., “File Portion A,” “File Portion B,” and “File Portion C”) to reconstruct a representation of the requested file **108**. In some implementations, if the entirety of the file **108** was encrypted by the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) prior to being divided into multiple chunks, the computing system may decrypt (**838**) the reassembled chunks to yield a copy of the original file **108**. The computing system **100** may, for example, perform such decryption using a private key corresponding to the public key that the computing system **100** sent (**818**) to the host device (e.g., the first device **102**). In other implementations, if the file chunks were separately encrypted by the computing system **100** prior to sending them to the respective client devices **202**, the computing system **100** may use a key (e.g., a private key corresponding to the public key that the computing system **100** sent (**818**) to the host device) to decrypt respective chunks of the file, prior to merging the various chunks to reconstruct the file **108**.

(148) In some implementations, the computing system **100** may determine if any file portions were not received. If the computing system **100** determines that any file portions were not received from a client device **202**, the computing system **100** may request the missing file portions from the host device (e.g., the first device **102**). In some implementations, upon determination that the file **108** has been successfully reconstructed, the computing system **100** may notify (**840**) the host device (e.g., the first device **102**) that the upload of the file **108** has completed.

(149) G. Example Implementations of Methods, Systems, and Computer-Readable Media in Accordance with the Present Disclosure

(150) The following paragraphs (M1) through (M19) describe examples of methods that may be implemented in accordance with the present disclosure.

(151) (M1) A method may be performed that involves determining, by a computing system, that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system; sending, from the computing system to the first remote device, first data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first remote device and a second remote device; receiving, by the computing system and from the first remote device, a first portion of the file; receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device via the wireless connection; and merging, by the computing system, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.

(152) (M2) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M1), and may further involve sending, from the computing system to the second remote device, second data to enable the second remote device to establish the wireless connection with the first remote device.

(153) (M3) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M2), and may further involve configuring, by the computing system, the first data to cause the first remote device to establish a wireless network to which the second remote device can connect, and configuring, by the computing system, the second data to cause the second remote device to connect to the wireless network established by the first remote device.

(154) (M4) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M2) or paragraph (M3), and may further involve receiving, by the computing system and from the first remote device, a first indication that the second remote device is within a proximity of the first remote device; and

determining, by the computing system, to send the second data to the second remote device based at least in part on the first indication.

(155) (M5) A method may be performed as described in any of paragraphs (M2) through (M4), and may further involve sending, from the computing system to the second remote device, third data that causes the second remote device to output a prompt requesting authorization for the second remote device to be used to assist in uploading the file from the first remote device to the computing system; and receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, a second indication that the second remote device received the authorization; wherein determining to send the second data to the second remote device may be further based at least in part on the second indication.

(156) (M6) A method may be performed as described in any of paragraphs (M1) through (M5), and may further involve sending, from the computing system to the first remote device, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file; and decrypting, by the computing system and using a second key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.

(157) (M7) A method may be performed that involves determining, by a computing system, that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system; determining, by the computing system, that at least a second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system; receiving, by the computing system and from the first remote device, a first portion of the file; receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device; and merging, by the computing system, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.

(158) (M8) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M7), and may further involve determining, by the computing system, that the second remote device is within a proximity of the first remote device; wherein determining that the second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system may be based at least in part on the second remote device being within the proximity of the first remote device.

(159) (M9) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M8), and may further involve receiving, by the computing system and from the first remote device, a first indication that the second remote device is within the proximity of the first remote device; wherein determining that the second remote device is within the proximity of the first remote device may be based at least in part on the first indication.

(160) (M10) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M8) or paragraph (M9), and may further involve sending, from the computing system to the second remote device, data that causes the second remote device to output a prompt requesting authorization for the second remote device to be used to assist in uploading the file from the first remote device to the computing system; and receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, a second indication that the second remote device received the authorization; wherein determining that the second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system may be based at least in part on the second indication.

(161) (M11) A method may be performed as described in any of paragraphs (M7) through (M10), and may further involve sending, from the computing system to the first remote device, first data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first remote device and the second remote device.

(162) (M12) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M11), and may further involve sending, from the computing system to the second remote device, second data to enable the second remote device to establish the wireless connection with the first remote device.

(163) (M13) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M12), and may further involve configuring, by the computing system, the first data to cause the first remote device to

establish a wireless network to which the second remote device can connect, and configuring, by the computing system, the second data to cause the second remote device to connect to the wireless network established by the first remote device.

(164) (M14) A method may be performed as described in any of paragraphs (M7) through (M13), and may further involve sending, from the computing system to the first remote device, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file; and decrypting, by the computing system and using a second key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.

(165) (M15) A method may be performed that involves determining, by a first device, that a file is to be uploaded from the first device to a remote computing system; establishing, by the first device, a wireless connection with at least a second device in proximity of the first device; dividing, by the first device, the file into at least a first portion and a second portion; sending, from the first device to the second device via the wireless connection, the first portion of the file; and sending, from the first device and to the remote computing system, the second portion of the file.

(166) (M16) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M15), and may further involve determining, by the first device, that at least the second device is within a proximity of the first device; sending, from the first device to the remote computing system, an indication that the second device is within the proximity; and after sending the indication, receiving, by the first device and from the remote computing system, first data to enable the wireless connection to be established between the first device and the second device.

(167) (M17) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M16), wherein determining that the second device is within the proximity may involve detecting a Bluetooth transmission identifying the second device.

(168) (M18) A method may be performed as described in paragraph (M16) or paragraph (M17), and may further involve receiving, by the first device and from the remote computing system, an instruction to use the first data to establish a wireless network to enable the wireless connection with the second device.

(169) (M19) A method may be performed as described in any of paragraphs (M15) through (M18), and may further involve receiving, by the first device and from the remote computing system, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file; and encrypting, by the first device and using the first key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.

(170) The following paragraphs (S1) through (S19) describe examples of systems and devices that may be implemented in accordance with the present disclosure.

(171) (S1) A computing system may include at least one processor, and at least one computer-readable medium encoded with instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, cause the computing system to determine that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system, to send, to the first remote device, first data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first remote device and a second remote device, to receive, from the first remote device, a first portion of the file, to receive, from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device via the wireless connection, and to merge the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.

(172) (S2) A computing system may be configured as described in paragraph (S1), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the second remote device, second data to enable the second remote device to establish the wireless connection with the first remote device.

(173) (S3) A system may be configured as described in paragraph (S2), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to configure the first

data to cause the first remote device to establish a wireless network to which the second remote device can connect, and to configure the second data to cause the second remote device to connect to the wireless network established by the first remote device.

(174) (S4) A system may be configured as described in paragraph (S2) or paragraph (S3), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to receive, from the first remote device, a first indication that the second remote device is within a proximity of the first remote device, and to determine to send the second data to the second remote device based at least in part on the first indication.

(175) (S5) A system may be configured as described in any of paragraphs (S2) through (S4), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the second remote device, third data that causes the second remote device to output a prompt requesting authorization for the second remote device to be used to assist in uploading the file from the first remote device to the computing system, to receive, from the second remote device, a second indication that the second remote device received the authorization, and to determine to send the second data to the second remote device further based at least in part on the second indication.

(176) (S6) A system may be configured as described in any of paragraphs (S1) through (S5), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the first remote device, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file, and to decrypt, using a second key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.

(177) (S7) A computing system may include at least one processor, and at least one computer-readable medium encoded with instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, cause the computing system to determine that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system, to determine that at least a second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system, to receive, from the first remote device, a first portion of the file, to receive, from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device, and to merge the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.

(178) (S8) A computing system may be configured as described in paragraph (S7), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to determine that the second remote device is within a proximity of the first remote device, and to determine that the second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system based at least in part on the second remote device being within the proximity of the first remote device.

(179) (S9) A computing system may be configured as described in paragraph (S8), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to receive, from the first remote device, a first indication that the second remote device is within the proximity of the first remote device, and to determine that the second remote device is within the proximity of the first remote device based at least in part on the first indication.

(180) (S10) A computing system may be configured as described in paragraph (S8) or paragraph (S9), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the second remote device, data that causes the second remote device to output a

prompt requesting authorization for the second remote device to be used to assist in uploading the file from the first remote device to the computing system, to receive, from the second remote device, a second indication that the second remote device received the authorization, and to determine that the second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system based at least in part on the second indication.

(181) (S11) A computing system may be configured as described in any of paragraphs (S7) through (S10), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the first remote device, first data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first remote device and the second remote device.

(182) (S12) A computing system may be configured as described in paragraph (S11), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the second remote device, second data to enable the second remote device to establish the wireless connection with the first remote device.

(183) (S13) A computing system may be configured as described in paragraph (S12), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to configure the first data to cause the first remote device to establish a wireless network to which the second remote device can connect, and to configure the second data to cause the second remote device to connect to the wireless network established by the first remote device.

(184) (S14) A computing system may be configured as described in any of paragraphs (S7) through (S13), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the first remote device, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file, and to decrypt, using a second key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.

(185) (S15) A first device may include at least one processor, and at least one computer-readable medium encoded with instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, cause the first device to determine that a file is to be uploaded from the first device to a remote computing system, to establish a wireless connection with at least a second device in proximity of the first device, to divide the file into at least a first portion and a second portion, to send, to the second device via the wireless connection, the first portion of the file, and to send, to the remote computing system, the second portion of the file.

(186) (S16) A first device may be configured as described in paragraph (S15), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the first device to determine that at least the second device is within a proximity of the first device, to send, to the remote computing system, an indication that the second device is within the proximity, and to receive, from the remote computing system and after sending the indication, first data to enable the wireless connection to be established between the first device and the second device.

(187) (S17) A first device may be configured as described in paragraph (S16), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the first device to determine that the second device is within the proximity based at least in part on detecting a Bluetooth transmission identifying the second device.

(188) (S18) A first device may be configured as described in paragraph (S16) or paragraph (S17), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the first device to receive, from the remote computing system, an instruction to use the first data to establish a

wireless network to enable the wireless connection with the second device.

(189) (S19) A first device may be configured as described in any of paragraphs (S15) through (S18), wherein the at least one computer-readable medium may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the first device to receive, from the remote computing system, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file, and to encrypt, and using the first key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.

(190) The following paragraphs (CRM1) through (CRM19) describe examples of computer-readable media that may be implemented in accordance with the present disclosure.

(191) (CRM1) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be encoded with instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor of a computing system, cause the computing system to determine that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system, to send, to the first remote device, first data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first remote device and a second remote device, to receive, from the first remote device, a first portion of the file, to receive, from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device via the wireless connection, and to merge the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.

(192) (CRM2) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM1), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the second remote device, second data to enable the second remote device to establish the wireless connection with the first remote device.

(193) (CRM3) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM2), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to configure the first data to cause the first remote device to establish a wireless network to which the second remote device can connect, and to configure the second data to cause the second remote device to connect to the wireless network established by the first remote device.

(194) (CRM4) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM2) or paragraph (CRM3), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to receive, from the first remote device, a first indication that the second remote device is within a proximity of the first remote device, and to determine to send the second data to the second remote device based at least in part on the first indication.

(195) (CRM5) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in any of paragraphs (CRM2) through (CRM4), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the second remote device, third data that causes the second remote device to output a prompt requesting authorization for the second remote device to be used to assist in uploading the file from the first remote device to the computing system, to receive, from the second remote device, a second indication that the second remote device received the authorization, and to determine to send the second data to the second remote device further based at least in part on the second indication.

(196) (CRM6) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in any of paragraphs (CRM1) through (CRM5), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the first remote device, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file, and to decrypt, using a second key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.

(197) (CRM7) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be encoded with instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor of a computing system, cause the computing system to determine that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system, to determine that at least a second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system, to receive, from the first remote device, a first portion of the file, to receive, from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device, and to merge the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.

(198) (CRM8) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM7), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to determine that the second remote device is within a proximity of the first remote device, and to determine that the second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system based at least in part on the second remote device being within the proximity of the first remote device.

(199) (CRM9) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM8), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to receive, from the first remote device, a first indication that the second remote device is within the proximity of the first remote device, and to determine that the second remote device is within the proximity of the first remote device based at least in part on the first indication.

(200) (CRM10) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM8) or paragraph (CRM9), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the second remote device, data that causes the second remote device to output a prompt requesting authorization for the second remote device to be used to assist in uploading the file from the first remote device to the computing system, to receive, from the second remote device, a second indication that the second remote device received the authorization, and to determine that the second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system based at least in part on the second indication.

(201) (CRM11) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in any of paragraphs (CRM7) through (CRM10), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the first remote device, first data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first remote device and the second remote device.

(202) (CRM12) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM11), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to send, to the second remote device, second data to enable the second remote device to establish the wireless connection with the first remote device.

(203) (CRM13) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM12), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the computing system to configure the first data to cause the first remote device to establish a wireless network to which the second remote device can connect, and to configure the second data to cause the second remote device to connect to the wireless network established by the first remote device.

(204) (CRM14) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in any of paragraphs (CRM7) through (CRM13), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the

computing system to send, to the first remote device, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file, and to decrypt, using a second key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.

(205) (CRM15) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be encoded with instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor of a first device, cause the first device to determine that a file is to be uploaded from the first device to a remote computing system, to establish a wireless connection with at least a second device in proximity of the first device, to divide the file into at least a first portion and a second portion, to send, to the second device via the wireless connection, the first portion of the file, and to send, to the remote computing system, the second portion of the file.

(206) (CRM16) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM15), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the first device to determine that at least the second device is within a proximity of the first device, to send, to the remote computing system, an indication that the second device is within the proximity, and to receive, from the remote computing system and after sending the indication, first data to enable the wireless connection to be established between the first device and the second device.

(207) (CRM17) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM16), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the first device to determine that the second device is within the proximity based at least in part on detecting a Bluetooth transmission identifying the second device.

(208) (CRM18) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in paragraph (CRM15) or paragraph (CRM17), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the first device to receive, from the remote computing system, an instruction to use the first data to establish a wireless network to enable the wireless connection with the second device.

(209) (CRM19) At least one non-transitory computer-readable medium may be configured as described in any of paragraphs (CRM15) through (CRM18), and may be further encoded with additional instructions which, when executed by the at least one processor, further cause the first device to receive, from the remote computing system, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file, and to encrypt, and using the first key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.

(210) Having thus described several aspects of at least one embodiment, it is to be appreciated that various alterations, modifications, and improvements will readily occur to those skilled in the art. Such alterations, modifications, and improvements are intended to be part of this disclosure, and are intended to be within the spirit and scope of the disclosure. Accordingly, the foregoing description and drawings are by way of example only.

(211) Various aspects of the present disclosure may be used alone, in combination, or in a variety of arrangements not specifically discussed in the embodiments described in the foregoing and is therefore not limited in this application to the details and arrangement of components set forth in the foregoing description or illustrated in the drawings. For example, aspects described in one embodiment may be combined in any manner with aspects described in other embodiments.

(212) Also, the disclosed aspects may be embodied as a method, of which an example has been provided. The acts performed as part of the method may be ordered in any suitable way. Accordingly, embodiments may be constructed in which acts are performed in an order different than illustrated, which may include performing some acts simultaneously, even though shown as sequential acts in illustrative embodiments.

(213) Use of ordinal terms such as “first,” “second,” “third,” etc. in the claims to modify a claim element does not by itself connote any priority, precedence, or order of one claim element over

another or the temporal order in which acts of a method are performed, but are used merely as labels to distinguish one claimed element having a certain name from another element having a same name (but for use of the ordinal term) to distinguish the claim elements.

(214) Also, the phraseology and terminology used herein is used for the purpose of description and should not be regarded as limiting. The use of “including,” “comprising,” or “having,” “containing,” “involving,” and variations thereof herein, is meant to encompass the items listed thereafter and equivalents thereof as well as additional items.

Claims

1. A method, comprising: determining, by a computing system, that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system; sending, from the computing system to the first remote device, first data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first remote device and a second remote device; receiving, by the computing system and from the first remote device, a first portion of the file; receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device via the wireless connection; and merging, by the computing system, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.
2. The method of claim 1, further comprising: sending, from the computing system to the second remote device, second data to enable the second remote device to establish the wireless connection with the first remote device.
3. The method of claim 2, further comprising: configuring, by the computing system, the first data to cause the first remote device to establish a wireless network to which the second remote device can connect, and configuring, by the computing system, the second data to cause the second remote device to connect to the wireless network established by the first remote device.
4. The method of claim 2, further comprising: receiving, by the computing system and from the first remote device, a first indication that the second remote device is within a proximity of the first remote device; and determining, by the computing system, to send the second data to the second remote device based at least in part on the first indication.
5. The method of claim 4, further comprising: sending, from the computing system to the second remote device, third data that causes the second remote device to output a prompt requesting authorization for the second remote device to be used to assist in uploading the file from the first remote device to the computing system; and receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, a second indication that the second remote device received the authorization; wherein determining to send the second data to the second remote device is further based at least in part on the second indication.
6. The method of claim 2, further comprising: sending, from the computing system to the second remote device, third data that causes the second remote device to output a prompt requesting authorization for the second remote device to be used to assist in uploading the file from the first remote device to the computing system; receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, an indication that the second remote device received the authorization; and determining, by the computing system, to send the second data to the second remote device based at least in part on the indication.
7. The method of claim 1, further comprising: sending, from the computing system to the first remote device, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file; and decrypting, by the computing system and using a second key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.
8. A method, comprising: determining, by a computing system, that a file is to be uploaded from a first remote device to the computing system; determining, by the computing system, that at least a second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the

computing system; receiving, by the computing system and from the first remote device, a first portion of the file; receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, a second portion of the file, the second remote device having received the second portion of the file from the first remote device; and merging, by the computing system, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file to generate a copy of the file.

9. The method of claim 8, further comprising: determining, by the computing system, that the second remote device is within a proximity of the first remote device; wherein determining that the second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system is based at least in part on the second remote device being within the proximity of the first remote device.

10. The method of claim 9, further comprising: receiving, by the computing system and from the first remote device, a first indication that the second remote device is within the proximity of the first remote device; wherein determining that the second remote device is within the proximity of the first remote device is based at least in part on the first indication.

11. The method of claim 10, further comprising: sending, from the computing system to the second remote device, data that causes the second remote device to output a prompt requesting authorization for the second remote device to be used to assist in uploading the file from the first remote device to the computing system; and receiving, by the computing system and from the second remote device, a second indication that the second remote device received the authorization; wherein determining that the second remote device is available to assist the first remote device in uploading the file to the computing system is based at least in part on the second indication.

12. The method of claim 8, further comprising: sending, from the computing system to the first remote device, first data to enable a wireless connection to be established between the first remote device and the second remote device.

13. The method of claim 12, further comprising: sending, from the computing system to the second remote device, second data to enable the second remote device to establish the wireless connection with the first remote device.

14. The method of claim 13, wherein: configuring, by the computing system, the first data to cause the first remote device to establish a wireless network to which the second remote device can connect, and configuring, by the computing system, the second data to cause the second remote device to connect to the wireless network established by the first remote device.

15. The method of claim 8, further comprising: sending, from the computing system to the first remote device, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file; and decrypting, by the computing system and using a second key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.

16. A method, comprising: determining, by a first device, that a file is to be uploaded from the first device to a remote computing system; establishing, by the first device, a wireless connection with at least a second device in proximity of the first device; dividing, by the first device, the file into at least a first portion and a second portion; sending, from the first device to the second device via the wireless connection, the first portion of the file; and sending, from the first device and to the remote computing system, the second portion of the file.

17. The method of claim 16, further comprising: determining, by the first device, that at least the second device is within a proximity of the first device; sending, from the first device to the remote computing system, an indication that the second device is within the proximity; and after sending the indication, receiving, by the first device and from the remote computing system, first data to enable the wireless connection to be established between the first device and the second device.

18. The method of claim 17, wherein determining that the second device is within the proximity comprises: detecting a Bluetooth transmission identifying the second device.

19. The method of claim 17, further comprising: receiving, by the first device and from the remote computing system, an instruction to use the first data to establish a wireless network to enable the

wireless connection with the second device.

20. The method of claim 16, further comprising: receiving, by the first device and from the remote computing system, a first key to encrypt the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file; and encrypting, by the first device and using the first key, the first portion of the file and the second portion of the file.
